Set Up Claude Code for Video Editing

A step-by-step guide to configure Claude so it can cut, animate, add B-roll and sound to your videos.

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What you are setting up

A video team has 7 jobs. In this system, Claude Code coordinates all the other tools:

Job	Tool	Cost
Editor (coordinator)	Claude Code, desktop app, running locally	Paid plan (start with the $20 plan)
Transcriber	Parakeet (built by Nvidia)	Free
Animator	Hyperframes (by HeyGen)	Free
Researcher / B-roll	Your browser (Google Chrome)	Already on your laptop
Screen editor	Tella, via its MCP connector (optional)	Paid: $13 per month on the annual plan
Sound designer	Epidemic Sound connector (optional)	Paid: $9.99 on the annual plan
Finisher	FFmpeg	Free

Tella and Epidemic Sound are paid and optional. A free route is listed near the end of this guide.

Part 1: Set up Claude Code

1 **Download the Claude desktop app**

Go to Anthropic's website, download the desktop app and install it. Create an account with Google or a username and password. If it is your first time in Claude, let it run its setup.

2 **Get a paid plan**

Upgrade to the $20 plan. There is no need to go higher at this point.

3 **Open Claude Code**

On the main screen, click **New** to start a new session. At the top left you will see Claude (chat and co-work) and **Claude Code**. Select **Claude Code**. The screen may look slightly different because things change often.

4 **Set it to Local**

Choose **Local**, so Claude uses your computer to do the work.

5 **Choose your working folder**

Click the folder option, add a new folder (or create one) and attach it. Claude will work inside it.

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6 **Set permissions to Auto**

Turn permissions to **Auto** so it can run without asking yes or no on every action.

7 **Pick one of the latest models for setup**

Setup is an important step, so use a latest model for it. After setup, it can run on a cheaper model.

8 **Turn on internet browsing**

At the bottom left, open **Settings**, then **Claude Code**. Turn on the setting that lets Claude browse the internet. This is what the researcher job needs.

9 **Ask Claude Code to build the system**

Go back to the main menu and start a new session. Claude Code is good at setting this up itself. Paste this prompt:

> *"Could you please create a video editing system for me? I'd like to use Hyperframes, FFmpeg, Tella, and Epidemic Sounds for this system. Run me through how to set it up step by step."*

You can go two ways: let Claude guide you step by step, or let it download and install what it needs. It will ask you to connect a couple of tools.

10 **Connect your tools**

On the left, go to **Customize**, then **Connectors**, and select the tool. If it is not added yet, click the **plus** button. For Tella and Epidemic Sounds, search for the tool and turn it on. It will ask you to log in in a separate browser, and a check mark appears once done. Claude downloads everything else itself. If it cannot find Hyperframes, search for "Hyperframes" on Google to find the repo link. You can also find it inside Connectors.

11 **Save it all as a skill and test**

Ask Claude to save everything as a **skill** on your computer. Once it is saved in that thread, open a **new thread** and give it a first test.

Part 2: Teach Claude your editing style

A skill is a file of instructions that Claude reads before it does the job. It holds your editing style: colors, fonts, animations, sounds and your preferences. Claude Code can build this file for you. Tell Claude what good looks like.

A **Start small**

Begin with small clips, usually just the hook of a video.

B **Give timestamped feedback**

When Claude gives you an edit, reply with specific feedback tied to timestamps. Be specific, for example about sound effects: reduce this one, remove that one completely.

C **Tell it to save what it learned**

After you give feedback, tell Claude to save what it learned into the skill itself. This is the key step: every new edit then improves your editing system.

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D **Repeat in a new session**

Start a new session with the updated skill and try another hook. The more videos you make and the more feedback you give, the better it gets. Notes you gave earlier are not repeated as mistakes.

Part 3: Run your first edit

1 **Add your raw file and run the skill**

Add the raw clip, then use this prompt:

> *"Please use my YouTube editing skill to edit this hook for my YouTube video."*

You can add extra instructions. For example: when you say "zoom", show a zoom; when you mention a sound effect, add one; and when you talk about animations, show three of the best ones from the skill's library.

Processing a clip can take 10 to 20 minutes. Claude copies the clip, transcribes it with Parakeet and cuts it together.

2 **Review V1 and give notes**

Watch the first version, then reply with timestamped notes. An example note: "Could you please add some suspense sound throughout this? I'd like for you to pick a track and add it to this hook."

3 **Save the learning**

Finish with this prompt:

> *"Can you learn from what we just did and add it to the skill?"*

Once the skill is ready, you can drop in the entire raw footage instead of working in sections. If you recorded in Tella, give Claude the file names. It has direct access, so you do not need to upload the files.

Optional: free route (no Tella, no Epidemic Sound)

If you do not want paid connectors, you can skip Tella and Epidemic Sound and use these free alternatives:

• **Screen recording:** OBS Studio. Claude then works on the recorded file. The direct Tella connector is not available with OBS.

• **Music and sounds:** YouTube Audio Library or Pixabay. Download tracks and give the folder to Claude.

In the setup prompt in Step 9, replace Tella and Epidemic Sounds with the tools you use.

Follow CodingSimplifiedSpace on YouTube for the full video walkthrough and more Claude, AI and coding tutorials. Questions? Ask in the comments of the video.